Unit 3/A: cram sheet

AP US History · Blue days Wed 11/4, Orange days Fri 11/6

Key ideas

1. The **Articles of Confederation** failed because the states kept their sovereignty: no power to collect taxes, regulate trade between states, or enforce anything.
2. The Convention's three compromises: **Great Compromise** (House by population, Senate equal), **Three-Fifths**, and **Commercial** (federal trade power, no export taxes).
3. **Hamilton's plan** (funding, assumption, the Bank) tied the rich to the new government and split the country into the first two parties.
4. The **Add-a-State Plan** (1787): appointed officials, a legislature at 5,000 adult free males, statehood at 60,000, no slavery north of the Ohio.
5. The **Kentucky and Virginia Resolutions** answered the Alien and Sedition Acts and became an influential early states' rights argument.

Articles to Constitution

Articles	**1781**	One house, one state one vote, no president, no national courts; states sovereign.
Weaknesses		Could not collect taxes, regulate interstate trade or enforce; amendments needed all 13.
Shays' Rebellion	**1786**	Private money paid the militia, so the Articles looked too weak, so leaders called a convention.
Convention	**1787**	Philadelphia, 12 states, Washington presiding, Madison's Virginia Plan; a new government.
Great Compromise		House by population, Senate two per state (Virginia Plan had both by population).
Three-Fifths		3/5 of enslaved people for House seats and direct taxes; slave trade protected until 1808.
Commercial		Federal power over foreign and interstate trade; no export taxes.
Ratification	**1788**	9 of 13 state conventions; Bill of Rights promised.

The West

Land Ordinance	**1785**	Township 6 by 6 miles = 36 sections of 640 acres; 16th section for schools.
Add-a-State	**1787**	Appointed governor, 3 judges, secretary; legislature at 5,000 adult free males; statehood at 60,000; no slavery.

Washington and Hamilton

First Congress	**1789**	Revenue Act (first independent income), departments, Judiciary Act, Bill of Rights.
Assumption		Federal takeover of state debts, so creditors back the government; capital goes south.
Bank	**1791**	Strict (Jefferson) vs. broad (Hamilton) construction, so the first parties form.
Whiskey Rebellion	**1794**	Federal excise; Washington's militia; two treason convictions, pardons; law enforced.

Foreign policy and 1798

Genêt	**1793**	French diplomat goes to the public; Washington stays neutral.
Jay Treaty	**1794**	Forts back, war avoided, impressment not stopped.
Pinckney's Treaty	**1795**	Mississippi, New Orleans deposit, 31st parallel.
XYZ	**1797**	Bribe demand, so anti-French fury, so the undeclared Quasi-War.
Alien and Sedition	**1798**	Three acts hit immigrants, one hit Democratic-Republican editors.
Kentucky / Virginia		Jefferson / Madison: states judge federal law; early states' rights; clashes with Supremacy.
Election of 1800		Peaceful party change; Jefferson-Burr tie decided by the House.

Traps

5,000 vs. 60,000	Legislature vs. statehood.
Excise vs. tariff	Whiskey tax was an excise.
1796 vs. 1800	Split ticket vs. tie in the House.
Federalists	1787 = pro-Constitution; 1790s = Hamilton and Adams's party.

Articles weakness, Constitution fix

One house, one state one vote	Two houses: House by population, Senate equal
No executive	A president who enforces the law (Article II)
No national courts	Supreme Court and federal courts (Article III)
Could levy taxes, could not collect them	Congress can lay and collect taxes
No power over trade between states	Congress regulates foreign and interstate commerce
No army, no enforcement	A national military; federal law enforced
Amendments needed all 13 states	Amendments need three-fourths of the states
States supreme	Supremacy Clause: federal law is the supreme law of the land

The first parties

	Federalists	Democratic-Republicans
Leaders	Hamilton, Adams	Jefferson, Madison
Government	Strong national government; broad construction	Smaller government, states' rights; strict construction
Who	Merchants, bankers, large farmers	Southern planters, small farmers, urban workers, new immigrants
Where	Port cities, New England	Farm areas, the South and West
Abroad	Pro-British (trade)	Pro-French (ideology)
Backed	Assumption, the Bank, Jay Treaty, Alien and Sedition Acts	Kentucky and Virginia Resolutions